School Council Meeting Minutes- Preston Public School

Wednesday, March 26, 2025

6:30-8:00 PM via Google Meet:

https://meet.google.com/rqe-hbrk-nao

Agenda:

Welcome -Marc

Preston Heights Community Group update -Kim

- Summer camp registration is open-flyers dropped off at school
- Fun field trips planned for camps like Ripley's Aquarium and Treetop trekking
- Starting "Hands on Creation" program at Preston Public-drop in. This week, doing clay monsters, board game station, bubble art. Can sign up via website: prestonheights.ca but can also drop in and parents can sign up on the day of.
- Food storage lockers by Cambridge Food Bank. For any families who are needing food-the lockers are in place, they can get a code and it's a self serve locker. Snacks/school snacks. Can register for this via email

Teacher/Principal updates -Marc

- Staffing:
  - ➢ No changes with 2024-25 staffing
  - ➢ 2025-26 staffing process is underway with required tasks needing to be completed almost daily (e.g., projected numbers, class organization, creating tentative assignments, departing/hiring education staff, setting up Kindergarten partnerships, interviewing, assigning class locations, adding portables?, etc.)

- Academics:
  - ➢ Our School Learning and Improvement Team and staff will be engaging in a full day of literacy learning on the March 31 PD day. The agenda was collectively created at today's team meeting with the support of our ERRT (Early Reading Resource Teacher)
  - ➢ New student profile database training called Clevr

- Facilities/Grounds:
  - ➢ Following last weeks' thaw, our creative playground has now been reopened
  - ➢ The WRDSB has issued a request that no "organized play" take place on our fields. As such, activities there will be limited
  - ➢ No updates yet on our capital projects slated for summer construction (accessible bathrooms, operable windows in every class, fan in staff bathroom, and bathroom in 3rd kindergarten room)

- Health & Safety:

- We had our yearly tornado drill last Wednesday and our spring fire drills will take place at the end of April and beginning of May

Miscellaneous:

- ➢ Mr. P-B has organized another talent show for our students. His School Day message describes all of the particulars. Students may enter via video submission or in-person auditions beginning April 1. Talent show date is to be determined
- ➢ Our PSL (Preston Soccer League) will begin again once the field conditions and weather are favourable
- ➢ Many thanks to School Council for the recent purchase of physical education equipment. With the $1,500 commitment, we were able to purchase new soccer balls, pinnies, badminton posts, racquets, shuttles, net and cart as well as some floor hockey pucks sideline official pinnines. With or school operating budget, we have also purchased 4 new multi-purpose goals
- ➢ The Boost Your Lunch website is now accepting Booster Juice orders from April 9 through June 25
- ➢ Our Preston spiritwear webstore will remain open through Friday, March 28

School Council Financials -Marc

Bingo:	$ 10,817.49
Pizza (821):	$ 19,842.88
Fundraising General (840-Chocolate Bar):	$ 1,728.42
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Total:	$ 32,388.79

Bingo brings in approx. $16,000 per year-more than what we previously estimated

Book Fair/Literacy Night Update/Feedback -Lindsay

- Sold over $7600 worth of books etc.
- We will get about $3500 in Scholastic dollars
- Every teacher had a wish list of books for their classroom-we were able to purchase all the books on their wish lists
- Approx. $2500 Scholastic dollars leftover to be used for different resources in classrooms. We have a couple years to spend those Scholastic dollars.
- Feedback: very well organized, huge turnout, parents and kids were so excited to have a Book Fair. The author who came to speak was very engaging and appreciative of the opportunity
- Kudos to Lindsay and Jessica for organizing the evening.

Monarch Waystation/Greening Discussion -Lindsay

Gardening Club Proposal

- Request from Marc-one of the DECEs (Shauna) who works in extended care-passionate about gardening. She would like to host/start a gardening club (school-wide). The whole kindergarten team is on board.
- Plan is to grow lettuce, herbs and possibly flowers, in a trough.
- We used to have 2 troughs but they aren't around anymore
- Request for School council to fund the following:
    - 2-3 troughs (approx. $300 each)
    - Greenhouses
    - Seed starting trays/soil/seeds etc.
    - Grow lights

- Shauna will take care of the gardens during the Summer
- Likely spot for troughs will be in back field
- Cost is approved by School Council

Monarch Waystation
- Need to add more stones to Monarch Waystation path-need to double up.
- Cost of stone: $700-could be more this year (approx. $700-1000)
- Students can actually walk through the garden and enjoy it
- This cost was approved by School Council

Spring Fundraiser? -Group discussion
- We are in a good financial position so there isn't a need for a fundraiser
- We don't have any specific purchases we are looking to save up for
- We will pass on a Spring fundraiser for now

School Spiritwear Update -Marc
Website will be closing after Friday March 28th

Year-end Picnic Discussion -Marc & Lindsay
- June 17th from 5-8pm is booked for Year-end Picnic
- Have previously had Food trucks-seem to be enjoyed by all. Benefits of food trucks is that they are easy for us, easy for families and at no cost to the school
- Discussion about possibly having other options for families as well as food trucks like pizza slices for sale. Need to consider how "volunteer-heavy" this would be and if we have the volunteers who can commit to working the pizza stand.
- There are food safety standards etc. that can make things complicated (like having a school BBQ etc)
- 2 food trucks have been booked-can be cancelled if need be
- Maybe a pizza place could come and sell pizza
- We have lots of time-continue this discussion at next school council meeting in April

Any Other Business?/Q & A
N/A

Upcoming Dates:
-March 31: PD Day
-April 18/21: School closed for Good Friday/Easter Monday

Next Meeting: Wednesday, April 23, 2025 6:30-8:00 PM